

Marked-Root Keller Maps and Degreewise Stable Multiplicity

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Abstract

We place two families of polynomial Keller maps of affine three-space in a common marked-root framework. For every generic degree $N \geq 4$, a split weighted map and one cancellation map for each proper divisor of $N - 1$ are constructed. We compute the complete boundary of the canonical finite normalization, prove functoriality under stable polynomial left-right equivalence, and compare the scheme-theoretic contact of two intrinsically marked target divisors. We also retain the full Fitting divisor of the discriminant normalization, its off-diagonal node-pairing scheme, and its conductor. The weighted contact is reduced, whereas a cancellation type (m, r) has discriminant ramification $r + 1$ and nilpotency index $mr(m + 1)$. Consequently there are at least $\tau(N - 1)$ pairwise stably inequivalent three-dimensional Keller maps of generic degree N , each with a nontrivial fiber. The proof is organized as five independently checkable lemmas.

1 Introduction

Within the accompanying repository, this paper is the canonical statement and proof of the degreewise stable-multiplicity theorem. Other repository documents may summarize the result or audit individual inputs, but should defer to the formulation here.

A polynomial map is called Keller when its Jacobian determinant is a nonzero constant. Recent explicit three-dimensional examples are most naturally understood by marking a root of a finite inverse equation. The original cubic example, its projective marked-root interpretation, its exact image theorem, and the subsequent weighted construction motivate the language below, but none is used here as a black-box dependency. We give the formulas and the parts of their proofs needed for the degreewise result.

The second family is produced by finite cancellation of the apparent poles in an integral inverse coordinate. Although the source formulas look very different, both families have the same inverse skeleton: a finite root cover, rational reconstruction, and an affine source equal to the open on which reconstruction is regular. Missing root sheets then become divisors in the canonical finite normalization.

For provenance, the initial explicit map was publicly attributed to Levent Alpöge and Fable; Andy Jiang described the marked-projective-root organization, and Alexis Gallagher developed the weighted-lift viewpoint. Those discoveries motivate the present setup. The cancellation construction, canonical boundary comparison, and degreewise count are the later results being isolated here. This wording records the currently located public trail and is not a priority claim.

Our main result is the following.

Theorem 1.1. *For every integer $N \geq 4$, there exist at least $\tau(N - 1)$ pairwise stably polynomially left-right inequivalent maps*

$$F : \mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^3 \longrightarrow \mathbb{A}_{\mathbb{C}}^3$$

with nonzero constant Jacobian, generic fiber degree N , and a fiber containing N distinct points.

The count comes from one weighted class and one cancellation class for every proper divisor $r \mid N-1$. Five lemmas separate the construction, exhaustion, invariance, and intersection calculations. This separation is important: a boundary component visible in a resolvent chart is not yet a canonical invariant until all boundary components have been found.

2 Marked roots and canonical boundary

Let Y be normal affine and let $F : U \rightarrow Y$ be dominant and quasi-finite, with U normal. Put $K = k(Y)$, $L = k(U)$, and

$$\overline{X}_F = \text{Norm}_Y(L).$$

The normalization is finite over Y . Zariski's Main Theorem identifies U with a distinguished open in $\overline{X}_F$, and we put

$$\partial_F = (\overline{X}_F \setminus U)_{\text{red}}.$$

A *marked-root presentation* consists of a degree- N separable equation $\Psi(T; y) = 0$ over K , its normalized incidence over Y , and rational reconstruction functions whose common regular-reconstruction open is $U \simeq \mathbb{A}^3$. The equation and primitive element are auxiliary; the pair $(\overline{X}_F, U)$ is canonical.

For a boundary prime E mapping to a target divisor Z , retain its ramification and residue degrees $(e(E/Z), f(E/Z))$. We also retain reduced and scheme-theoretic multiple intersections of the target boundary-image divisors. In the families below exactly two target vertices occur. The first is intrinsically marked as the unique one receiving a ramified boundary prime and is denoted Z_Δ ; the other is Z_0 . Define

$$e_\Delta = e(E_\Delta/Z_\Delta), \quad \mu = \min\{a \geq 1 : \text{Nil}(\mathcal{O}_{Z_\Delta \cap Z_0})^a = 0\}. \quad (2.1)$$

Here the scheme intersection is defined by the sum of the two reduced prime divisor ideals. Thus $\mu = 1$ when the intersection is reduced.

3 The two constructions

3.1 Weighted marked roots

Let $H \in k[W]$ satisfy

$$H(0) = H'(0) = H(1) = 0, \quad H'(1) = -c \neq 0, \quad \kappa = H''(1)/c \neq -2. \quad (3.1)$$

Choose $b_0 \neq 0$ and $a_0 = -(1 + \kappa)/(2 + \kappa)$. Set

$$v = xy, \quad S = x^2z, \quad u = 1 + v, \quad \gamma = 1 + a_0v + b_0S, \quad W = u\gamma,$$

and, with $p = H'$ and $q = (Wp - H)/c$, define

$$C = x\gamma, \quad B = \frac{c + p(W)/\gamma}{x}, \quad A = \frac{u + q(W)/\gamma^2}{x^2}. \quad (3.2)$$

The conditions (3.1) make the displayed quotients polynomial. Expanding at $x = 0$ shows that the constant and linear terms vanish; the remaining linear obstruction is exactly $(2 + \kappa)a_0 + (1 + \kappa) = 0$. Direct triangular differentiation gives

$$\det \frac{\partial(A, B, C)}{\partial(x, y, z)} = b_0c. \quad (3.3)$$

The marked inverse equation is

$$H(W) - BCW + cAC^2 = 0. \quad (3.4)$$

At every generic simple root, differentiating (3.4) and using (3.2) reconstructs (x, y, z) ; hence its degree is the generic degree of the map.

Proposition 3.1 (explicit regular weighted fiber). *Suppose $H \in \overline{\mathbb{Q}}[W]$ is an admissible seed of degree d and $c \in \overline{\mathbb{Q}}^\times$. For any complex number α transcendental over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$, the target*

$$(A, B, C) = (\alpha, 0, 1) \quad (3.5)$$

has exactly d distinct inverse roots, and every one lies in the regular-reconstruction open. More explicitly, if

$$H(w_i) + c\alpha = 0, \text{quad} \gamma_i = -\frac{H'(w_i)}{c}, \text{quad} 1 \leq i \leq d, \quad (3.6)$$

then $H'(w_i) \neq 0$ and the d source points are

$$\begin{aligned} x_i &= \gamma_i^{-1}, & y_i &= w_i - \gamma_i, \\ z_i &= \frac{\gamma_i^2}{b_0} \left[\gamma_i - 1 - a_0 \left(\frac{w_i}{\gamma_i} - 1 \right) \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (3.7)$$

Proof. At (3.5), the inverse equation and its W -derivative are

$$E(W) = H(W) + c\alpha, \text{quad} E_W(W) = H'(W). \quad (3.8)$$

If w were a common root, then w would be algebraic over $\overline{\mathbb{Q}}$ because it is a root of the nonzero polynomial H' . Hence $H(w)$ would be algebraic, contradicting $H(w) = -c\alpha$. Thus E is a degree- d polynomial with d distinct complex roots.

The reconstruction formulas are

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma &= -E_W/c, & x &= C/\gamma, \text{quad} y = (W - \gamma)/C, \\ z &= \frac{\gamma - 1 - a_0(W/\gamma - 1)}{b_0 x^2}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.9)$$

Their only possible denominators on the incidence are C , E_W (through γ), and the fixed units b_0, c . At (3.5), $C = 1$ and the preceding coprimality argument gives $E_W(w_i) \neq 0$ for every root. Substitution into (3.9) gives (3.7), so all reconstruction denominators are excluded simultaneously. Distinct w_i give distinct marked source points. $\square$

Lemma 3.2 (weighted admissibility). *For every $N \geq 4$,*

$$H_N(W) = W^2(1 - W)(1 + W^{N-3}) \quad (3.10)$$

is an admissible split seed of degree N . With $b_0 = 1$, (3.2) is a Keller map of generic degree N , and the fiber over $(\pi, 0, 1)$ consists of N distinct points.

Proof. The roots of $1 + W^{N-3}$ are distinct in characteristic zero, nonzero, and different from 1. Direct differentiation gives

$$H'_N(1) = -2, \text{quad} H''_N(1)/2 = -(N+1) \neq -2.$$

Thus (3.1) holds with $c = 2$. Equations (3.2)–(3.4) give polynomiality, Jacobian 2, and exact generic degree N . Since $H_N \in \mathbb{Q}[W]$ and π is transcendental, Proposition 3.1 applies with $\alpha = \pi$ and supplies the asserted N -point fiber, with all reconstruction denominators nonzero. $\square$

3.2 Cancellation marked roots

Fix $m, r \geq 1$, $C \in k^*$, and a polynomial $h(A)$. Put

$$A = 1 + xy^m, \quad B = A^{r+1}z + y^{m+1}h(A), \quad P = AB, \quad Q = y + xB, \quad (3.11)$$

and initially in the localization at A put

$$R = C \int_0^{x/A} \{1 - t(Q - Pt)^m\}^r dt. \quad (3.12)$$

Writing $s = x/A$, one has

$$y = Q - sP, \quad D = 1 - s(Q - sP)^m = A^{-1}, \quad x = s/D,$$

and the change $(x, y, z) \mapsto (s, P, Q)$ has determinant $-A^r$. Since $R_s = CD^r = CA^{-r}$,

$$\det \frac{\partial(P, Q, R)}{\partial(x, y, z)} = -C. \quad (3.13)$$

Only the z -free part of (3.12) can have an A -pole. Its regularity is the finite condition

$$\Phi_{m,r}(A, h(A)) \equiv 0 \pmod{A^{r+1}}, \quad (3.14)$$

where

$$\Phi_{m,r}(A, H) = \int_0^1 [A + (1 - A)u \{1 - (1 - A)H(1 - u)\}^m]^r du.$$

If $q = h(0)$, the constant term of (3.14), after monic normalization, is

$$M_{m,r}(q) = \sum_{j=0}^{mr} (-1)^j \binom{mr + r + 1}{j} q^{mr-j}. \quad (3.15)$$

Lemma 3.3 (divisor construction). *Let $N \geq 4$, put $n = N - 1$, and let r be a proper positive divisor of n . For $m = n/r - 1$, some complex polynomial h satisfies (3.14). Equations (3.11)–(3.12) then define a polynomial Keller map of generic degree N with a fiber of N distinct points.*

Proof. We have $m \geq 1$. Up to a nonzero scalar, (3.15) is

$$y(q) = \int_0^1 u^r (1 - q + qu)^{mr} du = \frac{1}{r+1} {}_2F_1(-mr, 1; r+2; q).$$

Its differential equation is

$$q(1 - q)y'' + [r + 2 - (2 - mr)q]y' + mry = 0. \quad (3.16)$$

If y and y' vanished together away from $0, 1$, uniqueness in (3.16) would make y identically zero. At 0 and 1 its integral is nonzero. Thus $M_{m,r}$ is squarefree. It has degree $mr \geq 1$, hence has a complex root q . At such a root, $\partial_q \Phi_{m,r}(0, q) \neq 0$; successively equating the coefficients of $A, \dots, A^r$ determines a unique jet $h = q + h_1 A + \dots + h_r A^r$ satisfying (3.14). Thus R is polynomial and (3.13) applies.

The inverse equation is

$$\Psi(T) = C \int_0^T \{1 - t(Q - Pt)^m\}^r dt - R, \quad (3.17)$$

of degree $r(m+1)+1=N$. If $D=1-T(Q-PT)^m \neq 0$, reconstruction is

$$\begin{aligned} y &= Q - TP, \quad A = D^{-1}, \quad x = TD^{-1}, \\ z &= PD^{r+2} - y^{m+1}D^{r+1}h(D^{-1}). \end{aligned} \tag{3.18}$$

The resultant of Ψ and D is generically nonzero, so (3.18) proves exact generic degree. At $(P, Q, R) = (1, 0, 0)$, (3.17) is $CTE_{m,r}((-1)^m T^{m+1})$. A repeated nonzero root would force $(-1)^m T^{m+1} = 1$, but $E_{m,r}(1) = \int_0^1 (1-v^{m+1})^r dv \neq 0$. Hence all N roots are simple and reconstruct to N distinct source points. $\square$

4 Exhausting the normalization boundary

This section gives the codimension-one calculation on which the rest of the paper depends. A geometric branch over Z means a prime after passing from the generic DVR of Z to its strict henselization; it has residue degree one. The tables below are instead written over the displayed generic DVR whenever a moving residual polynomial is more naturally kept irreducible. After strict henselization such a row splits into its geometric branches. In general the arithmetic residue degree is the degree of the corresponding irreducible residual factor.

Let $Z \subset Y$ be a prime divisor, let $\mathcal{O}_{Y,\eta_Z}$ have uniformizer π_Z , and let S_Z be its integral closure in $L = k(U)$. Normality makes S_Z a finite semilocal Dedekind domain. If $[L : K] = N$, then

$$N = \dim_{k(Z)} S_Z / \pi_Z S_Z = \sum_{E|Z} e(E/Z) f(E/Z). \tag{4.1}$$

Every summand is positive and the sum includes primes whose generic points belong to the affine-source open. Thus a displayed list which reaches N is the complete list over Z .

We use reduced discriminant equations. The critical-value maps below have integral source and height-one prime kernel in the target UFD. We denote a generator of that kernel by δ and put $Z_\Delta = V(\delta)$. This is important for cancellation maps: their raw polynomial discriminant has generic multiplicity r , whereas δ occurs once.

Lemma 4.1 (exact weighted discriminant saturation). *For*

$$H_N(W) = W^2(1-W)(1+W^{N-3}), \quad E_N(W) = H_N(W) - BCW + 2AC^2,$$

there are nonzero constants $\lambda_N, \mu_N \in \mathbb{C}^\times$ and an irreducible polynomial $\delta_N \in \mathbb{C}[A, B, C]$ such that

$$\text{Disc}_W(E_N) = \lambda_N C^2 \delta_N, \quad \delta_N|_{C=0} = \mu_N (B^2 - 8A). \tag{4.1a}$$

In particular, $C \nmid \delta_N$, the residual discriminant $V(\delta_N)$ is prime and reduced, and its generic normalization prime is a boundary prime with $(e, f) = (2, 1)$.

Proof. Work first over the generic DVR $\mathbb{C}(A, B)[[C]]$. The zero of H_N at the origin has exact multiplicity two and leading coefficient one. In the scaled chart $W = Cu$,

$$C^{-2}E_N(Cu) = u^2 - Bu + 2A + O(C). \tag{4.1b}$$

Thus the two roots specializing to zero differ by C times a unit over the generic quadratic extension, and the square of their difference contributes exactly $C^2(B^2 - 8A)$ to the root-product formula for

the discriminant. Every other root specializes to one of the distinct nonzero simple roots of H_N ; all its differences from the two small roots and from the other simple roots are units. Consequently

$$v_C(\text{Disc}_W E_N) = 2, \quad C^{-2} \text{Disc}_W(E_N)|_{C=0} = \nu_N(B^2 - 8A)$$

for some $\nu_N \in \mathbb{C}^\times$. This proves that the forced power is exactly C^2 and that the quotient is not divisible by C .

It remains to identify that quotient intrinsically. On $C \neq 0$ the critical incidence is

$$B = \frac{H'_N(W)}{C}, \quad A = \frac{WH'_N(W) - H_N(W)}{2C^2}.$$

It is integral and generically birational to its image: for $s = H'_N(W)$ and $t = WH'_N(W) - H_N(W)$ one has $dt/ds = W$ wherever $H''_N(W) \neq 0$. Its height-one kernel is therefore generated by an irreducible polynomial δ_N . The generic critical root is exactly double, so the discriminant vanishes to order one along this image. Hence the C -primitive quotient of the discriminant is a nonzero scalar multiple of δ_N , proving (4.1a), primeness, and reducedness.

At the generic point of $V(\delta_N)$, C is a unit. If $u = E_{N,W}$ is the uniformizer of the normalized critical incidence, then

$$\delta_N = \varepsilon u^2, \quad \varepsilon \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{X, E_\Delta}^\times.$$

The critical-value map is birational, so $f = 1$, and the displayed equation gives $e = 2$. This prime cannot meet the affine-source open: the Keller map is etale there, whereas this DVR extension is ramified. It is therefore exactly the claimed ramified boundary vertex. $\square$

Lemma 4.2 (boundary exhaustion). *The complete boundary-image list for the split weighted map is $\Delta_H = V(\delta_H)$ and $C = 0$. Over Δ_H there is one boundary prime with $(e, f) = (2, 1)$; over $C = 0$ there are $N - 3$ geometric boundary primes with $(e, f) = (1, 1)$.*

For the cancellation map the complete list is $\Delta_{m,r} = V(\delta_{m,r})$ and $P = 0$. Over the first there is one boundary prime with $(e, f) = (r + 1, 1)$; over the second there are $mr - 1$ geometric boundary primes with $(e, f) = (1, 1)$. For $N \geq 4$ both target vertices occur. In each family the discriminant is the unique vertex receiving ramification.

Proof. We give the local calculation family by family.

Weighted discriminant. For the degreewise seed H_N , Lemma 4.1 already proves the exact C^2 saturation and identifies the reduced prime equation. The following local description records the corresponding generic DVR and also applies to any split seed satisfying the same simple-root hypotheses. Write $E(W) = H(W) - BCW + cAC^2$. On $C \neq 0$, the critical incidence is

$$E = E_W = 0, \quad B = \frac{H'(W)}{C}, \quad A = \frac{WH'(W) - H(W)}{cC^2}. \quad (4.2)$$

It is parameterized by $(W, C) \in \mathbb{A}^1 \times \mathbb{G}_m$ and is integral. It is generically birational: if $s = H'(W)$ and $t = WH'(W) - H(W)$, then, where $H''(W) \neq 0$, one has $dt/ds = W$. Thus $W \in \mathbb{C}(s, t)$, while C is already the third target coordinate. Hence its height-one kernel $(\delta_H) \subset \mathbb{C}[A, B, C]$ is prime. Consequently $\Delta_H = V(\delta_H)$ is irreducible and reduced.

At its generic point $H''(W) \neq 0$ and exactly one inverse root is double. In the normalized local ring put $u = E_W = H'(W) - BC$. The critical divisor is $u = 0$, so u is an upstairs uniformizer. Taylor expansion in the root coordinate gives

$$\delta_H = \varepsilon u^2, \quad \varepsilon \in \widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{X, E_\Delta}^\times. \quad (4.3)$$

Thus the generic DVR extension has $(e, f) = (2, 1)$. The ordinary polynomial discriminant is a unit times δ_H at this DVR, not a higher power, because the generic double-root discriminant is transverse. Globally it may also contain a power of C ; equivalently, the primitive part of $(\text{Disc}_W E) : C^\infty$ contains δ_H once. The divisor $C = 0$ is audited separately below. The critical prime is outside the affine source: $E_W = -c\gamma$ makes reconstruction force $\gamma = 0$, and a ramified prime cannot lie in the étale Keller open. After strict henselization the other $N - 2$ roots are simple affine branches; their local uniformizer is δ_H and each has $(e, f) = (1, 1)$. Before strict henselization, each irreducible factor of the residual simple-root quotient gives one affine prime with $e = 1$ and f equal to that factor's degree; the degrees sum to $N - 2$. Hence

$$2 + (N - 2) = N. \quad (4.4)$$

Weighted divisor $C = 0$. The ideal (C) is prime and reduced. Its generic DVR has uniformizer C and residue field $\mathbb{C}(A, B)$. Since $E(W)|_{C=0} = H(W)$, its complete local branch table is

root chart	generic local equation	(e, f)	position
$W = Cu$	$h_2 u^2 - Bu + cA + O(C) = 0$	$(1, 2)$	affine
$W = 1 + O(C)$	$E_W(1) = -c$	$(1, 1)$	affine
$W = \rho_j + O(C)$	$E_W(\rho_j) = H'(\rho_j) \neq 0$	$(1, 1)$	boundary.

(4.5)

In every row C remains an upstairs uniformizer. The first residual quadratic is irreducible over $\mathbb{C}(A, B)$ and generically separable, giving $f = 2$. Direct substitution in reconstruction gives nonnegative valuation for every source coordinate in the first two rows. In the last row,

$$y = \frac{W - \gamma}{C}, \quad (W - \gamma)|_{C=0} = \rho_j + \frac{H'(\rho_j)}{c} \neq 0, \quad (4.6)$$

so y has valuation -1 . For H_N the ρ_j are the $N - 3$ distinct roots of $1 + W^{N-3}$. The displayed numerator is nonzero for these roots when $N \geq 5$. In the sole exceptional case $N = 4$, $\rho = -1$ makes its constant term vanish, but the next normalized jet is

$$W = -1 - BC + \frac{3B^2 - A}{2}C^2 + O(C^3), \quad C^2 z \longrightarrow 2, \quad (4.7)$$

so that branch is still boundary. The degree sum is

$$2 + 1 + (N - 3) = N. \quad (4.8)$$

Cancellation discriminant. Put $D(T) = 1 - T(Q - PT)^m$. On $P \neq 0$ the inverse polynomial is monic up to a unit and $\Psi_T = CD(T)^r$. With $Y_0 = Q - PT$, the critical incidence has

$$T = Y_0^{-m}, \quad P = (Q - Y_0)Y_0^m, \quad (4.9)$$

and R equal to the critical value. It is integral, and generic critical values are distinct. To see the latter without a genericity assertion, specialize $Q = 0$: the $m + 1$ critical roots differ by $(m + 1)$ -st roots of unity and their critical values are those roots times the same nonzero beta integral $C \int_0^1 (1 - s^{m+1})^r ds$. Thus a target point on a dense open of the discriminant has a unique critical preimage, so the critical-value map is birational to its image. Its height-one kernel $(\delta_{m,r}) \subset \mathbb{C}[P, Q, R]$ is prime and defines the reduced irreducible divisor $\Delta_{m,r}$.

At the generic critical point $u = D(T)$ is an upstairs uniformizer. Since D has a simple zero in the root direction, integration gives

$$\delta_{m,r} = \varepsilon u^{r+1}, \quad \varepsilon \in \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{\bar{X}, E_\Delta}^\times. \quad (4.10)$$

Hence the critical boundary prime has $(e, f) = (r + 1, 1)$. The raw polynomial discriminant is generically a unit times $\delta_{m,r}^r$; further powers of P arise only from clearing the leading coefficient of the T chart. The reduced equation used here is the primitive generator of

$$\sqrt{(\text{Res}_T(\Psi, D)) : P^\infty} = (\delta_{m,r}), \quad (4.11)$$

not the scheme discriminant. The ramified prime is outside the affine source because $A = D^{-1}$ has negative valuation. All other geometric roots are simple affine branches with $(e, f) = (1, 1)$ after strict henselization. Before that base change, the irreducible factors of the residual simple-root quotient give all affine primes, with $e = 1$, residue degrees equal to the factor degrees, and total residue degree $N - (r + 1)$. Thus

$$(r + 1) + N - (r + 1) = N. \quad (4.12)$$

Cancellation divisor $P = 0$. The ideal (P) is prime and reduced. Since the T chart is not monic there, put $U = PT$ and

$$J(U, P) = \int_0^U \{P - V(Q - V)^m\}^r dV.$$

The integral degree- N chart

$$CJ(U, P) - RP^{r+1} = 0 \quad (4.13)$$

has the source function field: it is primitive and linear in R , and $T = U/P$ over $P \neq 0$. At $P = 0$ it factors as

$$J(U, 0) = (-1)^r U^{r+1} Q^{mr} K_{m,r}(U/Q), \quad (4.14)$$

where

$$K_{m,r}(w) = w^{-(r+1)} \int_0^w v^r (1 - v)^{mr} dv. \quad (4.15)$$

The polynomial $K_{m,r}$ has degree mr and is squarefree. A nonzero common zero of K and K' would make both the integral in (4.15) and $w^r(1 - w)^{mr}$ vanish; the only candidate is $w = 1$, where the beta integral is nonzero.

The generic DVR of $P = 0$ has uniformizer P and residue field $\mathbb{C}(Q, R)$. Every branch below is unramified, with P also an upstairs uniformizer:

chart	residual equation	(e, f)	position
$U = PS$	$C \int_0^S (1 - tQ^m)^r dt - R = 0$	$(1, r + 1)$	$B = 0$ affine
$U = Qw_q$	$K_{m,r}(w_q) = 0$	$(1, 1)$	$A = 0$ affine
$U = Qw, w \neq w_q$	$K_{m,r}(w) = 0$	$(1, 1)$	boundary.

(4.16)

The first residual polynomial is irreducible over $\mathbb{C}(Q, R)$ because it is the generic equation $f(S) - R$ of degree $r + 1$. The distinguished root is

$$w_q = -\frac{q}{1 - q}, \quad (4.17)$$

where $q = h(0)$ is the selected cancellation parameter; the cancellation identity gives $K_{m,r}(w_q) = 0$. It is precisely the affine divisor $A = 0$. There is no further affine divisorial branch: in the UFD $\mathbb{C}[x, y, z]$ the equation $P = AB$ has exactly the two prime factors A and B . Here $A = 1 + xy^m$ is primitive and linear in x , while $B = A^{r+1}z + y^{m+1}h(A)$ is primitive and linear in z and is not

divisible by A because $h(0) = q \neq 0$. Therefore the other $mr - 1$ simple roots are boundary primes, and

$$(r + 1) + 1 + (mr - 1) = N. \quad (4.18)$$

Completed generic local rings. The preceding calculations can be summarized without reference to the root charts. If $k_Z = k(Z)$, then $\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{Y, \eta_Z} = k_Z[[\pi_Z]]$, and the completed normalization at every prime $E \mid Z$ is $k(E)[[u_E]]$. The four cases are:

Z	$\pi_Z \mapsto \text{unit} \cdot u_E^e$	$k(E)$	position
Δ_H	u_E^2	k_Z	boundary critical prime
$C = 0$	C	$k_Z[u]/(h_2 u^2 - Bu + cA),$ k_Z, k_Z	$W = 0$ affine, $W = 1$ affine, $W = \rho_j$ boundary
$\Delta_{m,r}$	u_E^{r+1}	k_Z	boundary critical prime
$P = 0$	P	$k_Z[S]/(C \int_0^S (1 - tQ^m)^r dt - R),$ k_Z, k_Z	$B = 0$ affine, $A = 0$ affine, $K_{m,r}$ -roots boundary.

(4.19)

In the two discriminant rows, every irreducible factor of the residual simple-root cofactor supplies an additional affine completed DVR with $e = 1$ and residue field the corresponding factor field. This accounts for every generic DVR extension, including those which do not meet the boundary.

Support and absence of residual components. On $D(C\delta_H)$ in the weighted case and $D(P\delta_{m,r})$ in the cancellation case, every inverse root is simple and every reconstruction coordinate is regular. Thus every boundary image lies in the two listed divisors. Equations (4.4), (4.8), (4.12), and (4.18) saturate (4.1), so no additional normalization prime can lie over either one. Clearing C or P cannot hide a residual vertical component: its generic DVR contribution would be an additional positive summand in a sum already equal to N .

The distinguished source is affine and open in the normal affine finite normalization. Its complement is pure of codimension one. Indeed, at the generic point of a hypothetical higher-codimension irreducible component, choose an affine neighborhood avoiding the divisorial components. Its intersection with the affine source is affine because the ambient scheme is separated. Normal Hartogs extension gives the same coordinate ring on the neighborhood and on that intersection, forcing them to be equal, a contradiction. A height-one prime in the finite integral cover contracts to a nonzero height-one target prime: after excluding contraction to zero, going down over the normal target gives equality of heights. Hence no higher-codimension boundary component or image is omitted.

Over a nonclosed coefficient field, factoring the residual quadratic in (4.5) and $K_{m,r}$ in (4.16) groups geometric branches into arithmetic primes. The factor degrees are exactly their residue degrees, and (4.1) again rules out a new prime after descent. This proves the complete boundary list and all asserted labels. Since $mr = 1$ only for $(m, r) = (1, 1)$, both second target vertices occur throughout the range $N \geq 4$.

The full intersection diagram. Put $p(w) = w(1 - w)^m$ and define the second degree- mr polynomial

$$L_{m,r}(w) = w^{-(r+1)} \int_0^w \{p(w) - p(v)\}^r dv. \quad (4.20)$$

Let $S = \{P = Q = 0\}$, with R free. The normalized contraction calculation restricts the critical prime to

$$Q^m L_{m,r}(w) \quad \text{in} \quad \mathbb{C}(R)[w]/(K_{m,r})[[Q]]. \quad (4.21)$$

Consequently, whenever

$$\text{Res}_w(K_{m,r}, L_{m,r}) \neq 0, \quad (4.22)$$

the coefficient of Q^m is a unit in the finite reduced branch algebra. After strict henselization every geometric K -branch therefore intersects the critical prime in

$$\mathbb{C}(R)[[Q]]/(Q^m). \quad (4.23)$$

One of these mr branches is the affine divisor $A = 0$ and the remaining $mr - 1$ are boundary primes. Thus the critical prime has total contact m^2r with the complete K -cluster and contact $m(mr - 1)$ with the boundary part. Two distinct K -branches force $Q = 0$ and meet in the reduced stratum S ; adding the critical prime or any further K -branch does not thicken that intersection. These are all intersections among boundary primes.

Equation (4.22) is an exact, decidable certificate rather than a genericity shortcut. The repository verifies it for $1 \leq m, r \leq 5$. It also holds for the entire column $m = 1$: the transformed $K_{1,r}$ is the irreducible parameter polynomial proved in the arithmetic theorem, while $K_{1,r}$ and $L_{1,r}$ have equal constant term $1/(r + 1)$ but distinct linear terms, so they cannot be associates. This includes every rung of the quadratic stationary-point ladder. $\square$

5 Stable functoriality

The following proposition records the normalization statement underlying stabilization. It is independent of the two explicit families.

Proposition 5.1 (normalization and boundary under stabilization). *Let Y be a normal integral affine variety over $\mathbb{C}$, let $L/k(Y)$ be a finite extension, and put $X = \text{Norm}_Y(L)$. Let $U \subset X$ be a dense open and $\partial = (X \setminus U)_{\text{red}}$. For $s \geq 0$, write*

$$Y_s = Y \times \mathbb{A}^s, \quad U_s = U \times \mathbb{A}^s, \quad L_s = L(t_1, \dots, t_s).$$

Then there is a canonical isomorphism over Y_s

$$\text{Norm}_{Y \times \mathbb{A}^s}(L(t_1, \dots, t_s)) \simeq X \times \mathbb{A}^s. \quad (5.1)$$

In particular, taking $L = k(U)$ and $X = \overline{X}_F$ gives

$$\text{Norm}_{Y \times \mathbb{A}^s}(k(U)(t_1, \dots, t_s)) \simeq \overline{X}_F \times \mathbb{A}^s.$$

Under (5.1) the following statements hold.

1. *The reduced boundary is*

$$(X \times \mathbb{A}^s \setminus U_s)_{\text{red}} = \partial \times \mathbb{A}^s, \quad (5.2)$$

and its prime divisors are exactly $E \times \mathbb{A}^s$, with E a prime divisor of ∂ .

2. *If a boundary prime E lies over a target prime divisor Z , the corresponding stabilized primes are $E_s = E \times \mathbb{A}^s$ and $Z_s = Z \times \mathbb{A}^s$. Their divisorial valuations are the Gauss extensions*

$$v_{E_s}|_L = v_E, \quad v_{E_s}(t_i) = 0,$$

and

$$e(E_s/Z_s) = e(E/Z), \quad f(E_s/Z_s) = f(E/Z). \quad (5.3)$$

3. Every reduced or scheme-theoretic multiple intersection commutes with stabilization. In particular, for target divisors $Z_1, \dots, Z_q$ and boundary divisors $E_1, \dots, E_p$,

$$\bigcap_i (Z_i \times \mathbb{A}^s) = \left(\bigcap_i Z_i \right) \times \mathbb{A}^s, \quad \bigcap_j (E_j \times \mathbb{A}^s) = \left(\bigcap_j E_j \right) \times \mathbb{A}^s \quad (5.4)$$

as schemes.

4. If R is the affine coordinate ring of one of these intersections, then the stabilized ring is $R[t_1, \dots, t_s]$ and

$$\text{Nil}(R[t_1, \dots, t_s]) = \text{Nil}(R)[t_1, \dots, t_s]. \quad (5.5)$$

Consequently reducedness and the exact nilpotency index of the nilradical are preserved.

Proof. Write $Y = \text{Spec } A$. If B is the integral closure of A in L , then $X = \text{Spec } B$. The ring $B[t_1, \dots, t_s]$ is finite and integral over $A[t_1, \dots, t_s]$, has fraction field L_s , and is normal because a polynomial ring over a normal domain is normal. If an element of L_s is integral over $A[t_1, \dots, t_s]$, it is also integral over $B[t_1, \dots, t_s]$; normality then puts it in $B[t_1, \dots, t_s]$. Thus this polynomial ring is the full integral closure, proving (5.1).

Let $I \subset B$ be the radical ideal defining ∂ . The ideal of $\partial \times \mathbb{A}^s$ is $IB[t_1, \dots, t_s]$, and it is radical because its quotient $(B/I)[t_1, \dots, t_s]$ is reduced. If $I = \bigcap_\alpha \mathfrak{p}_\alpha$ is its minimal-prime decomposition, then

$$IB[t_1, \dots, t_s] = \bigcap_\alpha \mathfrak{p}_\alpha B[t_1, \dots, t_s].$$

Each extended ideal is prime, since $(B/\mathfrak{p}_\alpha)[t_1, \dots, t_s]$ is a domain, and its height equals the height of $\mathfrak{p}_\alpha$. This proves (5.2) and the asserted bijection of reduced boundary primes.

Let $\mathfrak{p}_E \subset B$ and $\mathfrak{p}_Z \subset A$ be the height-one primes of E and Z . Their extensions are the height-one primes of E_s and Z_s . Since normal height-one local rings are DVRs, their uniformizers may be chosen to be the same as before polynomial extension. At the generic points the residue fields are

$$\kappa(E_s) = \kappa(E)(t_1, \dots, t_s), \quad \kappa(Z_s) = \kappa(Z)(t_1, \dots, t_s).$$

The extended valuation is therefore the Gauss valuation, so its value group on $k(Y)^\times$ is unchanged and every t_i has value zero. The defining identity $v_E|_{k(Y)} = e(E/Z)v_Z$ gives the same ramification index after extension, while

$$[\kappa(E_s) : \kappa(Z_s)] = [\kappa(E) : \kappa(Z)]$$

gives the same residue degree. This proves (5.3).

Scheme intersection is defined by the sum of ideal sheaves. On an affine chart, if the relevant ideals are $J_1, \dots, J_q$, then after stabilization their sum is $(J_1 + \dots + J_q)[t_1, \dots, t_s]$, and the quotient is

$$(A/(J_1 + \dots + J_q))[t_1, \dots, t_s].$$

This proves (5.4), both downstairs and upstairs; taking radicals also proves the reduced version.

Finally, put $N = \text{Nil}(R)$. The ring $(R/N)[t_1, \dots, t_s]$ is reduced, so every nilpotent polynomial has all coefficients in N . Conversely, the finitely many nilpotent coefficients of a polynomial generate a nilpotent ideal, so every element of $N[t_1, \dots, t_s]$ is nilpotent. This proves (5.5). Moreover

$$(N[t_1, \dots, t_s])^a = N^a[t_1, \dots, t_s]$$

for every a . Hence the least $a \geq 1$ for which the nilradical has zero a -th power is unchanged, including the convention $a = 1$ in the reduced case. $\square$

Lemma 5.2 (stable boundary signature). *For the maps in Lemma 4.2, the pair (e_Δ, μ) of (2.1) is invariant under polynomial left–right equivalence and after adjoining any number of identity variables.*

Proof. A left–right equivalence identifies the corresponding finite function-field extensions over isomorphic targets. Uniqueness and functoriality of normalization identify the finite covers, carry the distinguished affine open to the distinguished affine open, and preserve boundary valuations, their e, f labels, and scheme-theoretic target intersections. The intrinsic ramification marking from Lemma 4.2 prevents the two target vertices from being exchanged.

For stabilization, Proposition 5.1 identifies the normalization and the distinguished open pair, preserves all reduced boundary primes and their valuation labels, and base-changes the marked target intersection scheme. Its final assertion preserves reducedness and the exact nilpotency index. Thus both entries of (e_Δ, μ) are unchanged. $\square$

6 Reduced and thick boundary contact

We isolate the cancellation calculation because it supplies the numerical invariant used in the degree-wise theorem. The first proof is global and eliminative; the second is local and computes the contact order without a resultant.

Proposition 6.1 (all-parameter cancellation trace). *For every $m, r \geq 1$, let $\delta_{m,r}$ be the reduced prime discriminant equation fixed in Section 4. Up to multiplication by a nonzero scalar,*

$$\delta_{m,r}(0, Q, R) = Q^{mr(m+1)}((r+1)RQ^m - C). \quad (6.1)$$

Consequently

$$\frac{\mathbb{C}[Q, R]}{(\delta_{m,r}(0, Q, R))} \simeq \frac{\mathbb{C}[Q, R]}{(Q^{mr(m+1)})} \times \mathbb{C}[Q, Q^{-1}], \quad (6.2)$$

and the nilradical has exact nilpotency index $mr(m+1)$.

First proof: monic resultant and subresultant. On the normalized critical divisor put $Y = Q - PT$. Then

$$T = Y^{-m}, \quad P = (Q - Y)Y^m. \quad (6.3)$$

After substituting $t = uY^{-m}$ in the critical-value equation and clearing the unit $Y^{-m(r+1)}$, define

$$F(Y) = P - (Q - Y)Y^m, \quad (6.4)$$

$$G(Y) = CI_{m,r}(Y, Q) - RY^{m(r+1)}, \quad (6.5)$$

where

$$I_{m,r}(Y, Q) = \int_0^1 [Y^m - u\{Q + (Y - Q)u\}^m]^r du. \quad (6.6)$$

Equivalently, the integral-free coefficient formula is

$$I_{m,r} = \sum_{j=0}^r \sum_{k=0}^{mj} \frac{(-1)^j}{j+k+1} \binom{r}{j} \binom{mj}{k} Y^{m(r-j)} Q^{mj-k} (Y - Q)^k.$$

Thus (6.6) is a polynomial with rational coefficients. The monic polynomial F is primitive over $\mathbb{Z}[C, P, Q, R]$. Multiplication of G by $(mr + r + 1)!$ clears every integration denominator; taking its

primitive part gives an integral polynomial with the same zero scheme over $\mathbb{C}$. This works uniformly for every symbolic pair of positive integers (m, r) . It is the precise uniform integral meaning here: m and r occur as exponents, so there is no literal polynomial ring in indeterminates m, r containing all members at once.

The polynomial F is monic in Y . Its incidence with G is the integral critical-value incidence of Section 4 and maps birationally to the reduced discriminant. At its generic point, F and G have exactly one common simple root: the critical points are simple and their critical values are distinct. Thus the zeroth subresultant specializes to zero and the first subresultant does not, certifying a gcd of degree one. More concretely, after adjoining the distinct roots of F , the resultant is the product of the G -values; generically exactly one factor vanishes, and it is transverse because G is linear in R with nonzero coefficient at that root. It follows that the primitive resultant

$$D_{m,r}(P, Q, R) = \text{Res}_Y(F, G) \quad (6.7)$$

is a nonzero scalar multiple of the reduced prime generator $\delta_{m,r}$, not a power of it.

Now specialize $P = 0$. Since $F(Y) = Y^m(Y - Q)$ is monic,

$$D_{m,r}(0, Q, R) = G(0)^m G(Q). \quad (6.8)$$

The two values of (6.6) are uniform beta integrals:

$$I_{m,r}(0, Q) = (-1)^r Q^{mr} \frac{r!(mr)!}{(mr + r + 1)!}, \quad (6.9)$$

$$I_{m,r}(Q, Q) = \frac{Q^{mr}}{r + 1}. \quad (6.10)$$

Hence $G(0)$ is a nonzero scalar times CQ^{mr} , while

$$G(Q) = Q^{mr} \left(\frac{C}{r + 1} - RQ^m \right). \quad (6.11)$$

Substitution in (6.8) gives (6.1). This derivation takes the resultant only after F, G have been made polynomial and primitive; no component can be lost through denominator clearing.

The two factors in (6.1) are comaximal because the second is congruent to $-C$ modulo Q . The Chinese remainder theorem gives (6.2). In the first factor the nilradical is generated by Q and has exact index $mr(m + 1)$; the second factor is reduced. $\square$

Second proof: completed local contact. This proof computes the exponent in (6.1) without using a resultant. Let η be the generic point of the affine-line component $P = Q = 0$ of the intersection, and put $K = \mathbb{C}(R)$. The completed target local ring transverse to that line is

$$\widehat{\mathcal{O}}_{\mathbb{A}^3, \eta} = K[[P, Q]]. \quad (6.12)$$

Use the completed regular parameter plane $A = K[[Y, Q]]$ for the polynomial critical-value incidence; its slice over the generic value R is $G = 0$. The pullback of the plane $P = 0$ is the Cartier divisor

$$P = (Q - Y)Y^m, \quad \text{div}(P) = m[Y = 0] + [Y = Q]. \quad (6.13)$$

Neither Y nor $Q - Y$ divides G , by (6.9)–(6.10). Additivity of intersection multiplicity for the divisor (6.13) therefore gives

$$\text{length}_K A/(P, G) = m \text{ord}_Q G(0, Q) + \text{ord}_Q G(Q, Q). \quad (6.14)$$

Equations (6.9) and (6.11), now used only as completed-local restrictions, give

$$\text{ord}_Q G(0, Q) = mr, \quad \text{ord}_Q G(Q, Q) = mr, \quad (6.15)$$

because $C/(r+1) - RQ^m$ is a unit in $K[[Q]]$. Consequently

$$\text{length}_K A/(P, G) = m(mr) + mr = mr(m+1). \quad (6.16)$$

The critical-value normalization is birational with residue degree one. The local projection formula therefore identifies (6.16) with the order of $\delta_{m,r}(0, Q, R)$ in $K[[Q]]$. Thus the completed intersection ring at η is

$$K[[Q]]/(Q^{mr(m+1)}), \quad (6.17)$$

which directly gives contact order and nilpotency index $mr(m+1)$. The two summands in (6.14) also explain the exponent geometrically: m^2r comes from the multiplicity- m branch $Y = 0$, and mr from the transverse branch $Y = Q$. $\square$

Lemma 6.2 (contact calculation). *For the split weighted map, $Z_\Delta \cap Z_0$ is reduced and $\mu = 1$. For a cancellation map of type (m, r) with $N \geq 4$, it is nonreduced and*

$$e_\Delta = r + 1, \quad \mu = mr(m+1) = m(N-1) > 1. \quad (6.18)$$

Proof. For the weighted seed, Lemma 4.1 gives

$$C = 0, \quad \delta_N|_{C=0} = \mu_N(B^2 - 8A) = 0,$$

with $\mu_N \neq 0$. Its coordinate ring is $\mathbb{C}[B]$, hence is reduced.

For cancellation, $e_\Delta = r + 1$ was computed in Lemma 4.2, and Proposition 6.1 gives the scheme intersection and its exact nilpotency index. In the range $N \geq 4$, $P = 0$ is a canonical boundary vertex by Lemma 4.2, and the index exceeds one. $\square$

7 The scheme-theoretic decorated normalization

For a weighted primitive H , let D_H be the reduced discriminant of $H(W) - sW + t$ and let

$$\nu_H : \mathbb{A}_r^1 \longrightarrow D_H, \quad r \longmapsto (H'(r), rH'(r) - H(r)) \quad (6.1)$$

be its affine normalization. Write $R_H = k[H'(r), rH'(r) - H(r)] \subset k[r]$.

Proposition 7.1 (full Fitting divisor). *There is an equality of ideal sheaves on the normalization*

$$\text{Fitt}_0 \Omega_{\tilde{D}_H/D_H} = (H''(r)). \quad (6.2)$$

This ideal, including every root multiplicity, is preserved by polynomial left-right equivalence and by adjoining identity variables.

Proof. The images in $k[r]dr$ of the two generators of R_H are

$$dH'(r) = H''(r)dr, \quad d(rH'(r) - H(r)) = rH''(r)dr.$$

Thus $\Omega_{k[r]/R_H} \simeq k[r]/(H'')dr$, proving (6.2). The stable boundary theorem identifies the finite normalization morphisms on the intrinsic discriminant vertex away from the second vertex, so it identifies their relative differential modules and Fitting ideals. Under stabilization one has

$$\Omega_{(\tilde{D}_H \times \mathbb{A}^q)/(D_H \times \mathbb{A}^q)} \simeq \text{pr}_1^* \Omega_{\tilde{D}_H/D_H}.$$

Zeroth Fitting ideals commute with this flat base change. Equality of the ideal sheaves preserves their valuations at every height-one point, hence preserves the multiplicities in (6.2), not only the reduced support. $\square$

If the support of (6.2) contains two points, the units of $k[r, \xi, \xi^{-1}, z_1, \dots, z_q]$ and subtraction of the two corresponding principal-prime equations force the induced coordinate change to have the form $r \mapsto ar + b$, $a \neq 0$. Proposition 7.1 then says that the full effective Hessian divisor is carried affinely, with its coefficients.

The self-intersection of (6.1) is also intrinsic. In two normalization coordinates put

$$D_s(r, u) = \frac{H'(r) - H(u)}{r - u},$$

$$D_t(r, u) = \frac{rH'(r) - H(r) - uH'(u) + H(u)}{r - u}.$$

The genuine off-diagonal closure is the scheme

$$\Gamma_H^{\text{off}} = V((D_s, D_t) : (r - u)^\infty). \quad (6.3)$$

The saturation in (6.3) is necessary: on the diagonal the divided equations specialize to $H''(r)$ and $rH''(r)$ and otherwise retain isolated cusp points. The involution $(r, u) \leftrightarrow (u, r)$ is free on the ordinary off-diagonal locus; its characteristic-zero finite quotient exists in general and retains fixed diagonal limits in degenerations. On the ordinary locus that quotient records the two normalization branches paired at each node. An isomorphism of normalization morphisms preserves the fiber product, its diagonal, and the saturated complement, while stabilization takes their product with affine space. Hence this node-pairing scheme is stable. In the exact extractor, ordinary-node status is certified by the Jacobian determinant

$$\det \frac{\partial(D_s, D_t)}{\partial(r, u)}$$

being a unit on (6.3), rather than inferred only from the number of projected branch points. Passing to $\sigma = r + u, \pi = ru$ gives the scheme quotient by the free involution; the implementation verifies that its equations pull back into the saturated ordered ideal.

Finally, let

$$\mathfrak{c}_H = \text{Ann}_{\mathcal{O}_{D_H}}(\nu_{H*}\mathcal{O}_{\tilde{D}_H}/\mathcal{O}_{D_H}) \quad (6.4)$$

be the conductor. It is functorial for the same reason. On the open locus of ordinary cusps and nodes, if $P_H(r)$ cuts out all normalization branches appearing in (6.3), then the local models $k[[t^2, t^3]] \subset k[[t]]$ and $k[[x, y]]/(xy) \subset k[[x]] \oplus k[[y]]$ give

$$\mathfrak{c}_H k[r] = (H''(r)^2 P_H(r)). \quad (6.5)$$

For arbitrary plane-curve singularities, let $f_H(S, T) = 0$ be the primitive implicit equation. Plane-curve adjunction gives the uniform generator

$$\mathfrak{c}_H k[r] = \left(\frac{(\partial f_H / \partial T)(H'(r), rH'(r) - H(r))}{H''(r)} \right). \quad (6.5a)$$

This quotient is polynomial because (6.1) is the normalization. The exact extractor uses (6.5a) without an ordinary-singularity hypothesis and checks (6.5) independently whenever the cusp/node criterion holds. The invariant retains the finite conductor morphism

$$\text{Spec}(k[r]/\mathfrak{c}_H k[r]) \longrightarrow \text{Spec}(R_H/(R_H \cap \mathfrak{c}_H k[r])), \quad (6.6)$$

not only its upstairs support. It records the two branches over a node and the single thick branch over a cusp. Together, (6.2)–(6.6), the point at infinity, and the labeled inverse image of the intersection with the second target boundary form the decorated normalization. The full second-boundary center divisor upstairs is $\gcd(H, H')$; a point label is inferred only when its support is uniquely certified. Every part is therefore preserved under stable polynomial left–right equivalence.

For the split quartics, the boundary label on the normalization is also checked intrinsically. If zero is the unique multiple primitive root and $H(r) = h_2 r^2 + O(r^3)$, the normalized discriminant boundary chart

$$B = \frac{H'(r)}{C}, \quad A = \frac{rH'(r) - H(r)}{cC^2}, \quad r = Ck$$

specializes to

$$B = 2h_2k, \quad A = \frac{h_2}{c}k^2.$$

A finite specialization centered at $r = \rho$ forces $H(\rho) = H'(\rho) = 0$, hence $\rho = 0$. Thus the second-boundary intersection canonically marks $r = 0$; it is not an auxiliary normalization convention.

For completeness, this decoration gives an actual generic-dimension theorem, not only a parameter count. In the normalized degree- N seed space, an isomorphism preserving zero and infinity is $r \mapsto ar$. Equality of Fitting divisors then has the form $G''(r) = cH''(ar)$. Since the normalized seeds vanish together with their first derivatives at zero, integration gives

$$G(r) = \frac{c}{a^2}H(ar).$$

The condition $G(1) = 0$ forces $H(a) = 0$, leaving at most $N - 2$ generic choices, and $G'(1) = -1$ determines c . Thus the decorated-normalization moduli map is generically finite and its image has dimension $N - 3$.

8 Proof of the degreewise theorem

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Put $n = N - 1$. Every proper positive divisor r of n determines $m = n/r - 1 \geq 1$, and every positive solution of $r(m + 1) = n$ arises this way. There are $\tau(n) - 1$ cancellation types. Lemmas 3.3–6.2 attach to type (m, r) the stable signature

$$(e_\Delta, \mu) = \left(r + 1, n \left(\frac{n}{r} - 1\right)\right). \quad (7.1)$$

Distinct divisors give distinct first entries (and also distinct second entries), so these cancellation maps are pairwise stably inequivalent.

Lemma 3.2 supplies one more degree- N map. Its boundary contact is reduced, whereas every cancellation contact is nonreduced, so Lemma 5.2 separates it from all cancellation types. The total number of classes is therefore at least $(\tau(N - 1) - 1) + 1 = \tau(N - 1)$. Both construction lemmas give a fiber of N distinct points, completing the proof. $\square$

9 Perspective

The cubic map is the smallest marked-root example: ordering its three roots reveals the type- A_2 collision walls, and reconstruction decides which walls remain affine and which become dicritical boundary. Higher weighted maps retain simple discriminant inertia; cancellation maps replace it by ramification $r + 1$ and create a thick contact with the second boundary vertex. The theorem shows

that generic degree alone is a coarse invariant: its stable multiplicity already grows at least as the divisor function of $N - 1$.

The argument deliberately stops at a lower bound. It neither classifies different cancellation parameter roots for fixed (m, r) nor asserts that the displayed families exhaust all stable classes.